



When the automation continuum is used to create a collaborative environment, it brings together a varied group of players and a large amount of data, which can present numerous important issues. Fortunately, they can be resolved by utilising the same technologies that made the automation continuum possible in the first place.

These are some of the difficulties:

Proximity to Human Collaborators

It is dangerous to have ‘fragile’ humans working alongside powerful machines. For the time being, this vulnerability has been minimised by simply prohibiting humans from working in close proximity to operational robots, frequently by separating man and machine with shields and guardrails, or even by placing each in an entirely separate room. As people increasingly live in close quarters with their partnering robots (also known as collaborative robots or “cobots”) in collaborative workplaces, such separation measures are no longer practicable.

Cobots, in addition to mechanical safeguards, rely on a variety of sensors and technology, such as artificial intelligence, to make sense of the world around them and to operate securely in it. A new robot will find itself installed or navigating through an increasingly complex environment that is densely packed with sensor-intensive Internet of Things devices, with many more on the way.